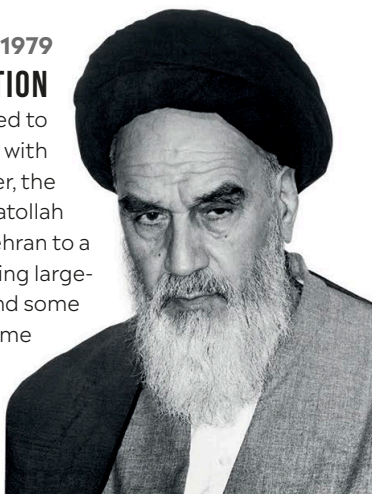


11 February 1979

THE IRANIAN REVOLUTION

The Shah of Iran was forced to depart amid dissatisfaction with his regime. Sixteen days later, the exiled opposition leader Ayatollah

Khomeini returned to Tehran to a hero's welcome. Following large-scale demonstrations and some fighting, the Shah's last prime minister fled the country, leaving Iran in the hands of the revolutionaries.



▷ Ayatollah Khomeini

“We have set as our goal the worldwide spread of the influence of Islam.”

AYATOLLAH KHOMEINI,
FROM HIS BOOK COMMENTARIES
ON THE MEANS OF SALVATION, 1986

1 January 1979 The US
and People's Republic
of China establish full
diplomatic relations

1979

4 May 1979 Margaret Thatcher
becomes Prime Minister of
Britain, bringing a free-market
ideology to power

17 July 1979

REVOLUTION IN NICARAGUA

Reflecting growing opposition to the Somoza dynasty that had ruled Nicaragua for 42 years, Sandinista rebels launched a guerrilla campaign. The oppressive measures the government adopted to suppress the rising eventually led it to lose US support. Amid renewed unrest after the murder of a leading newspaper editor, the revolutionary forces gradually spread their hold across the country and on 17 July entered the capital, Managua. President Somoza resigned and went into exile, leaving the country in Sandinista hands.



△ Sandinista National Liberation Front propaganda poster